Modals

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Modals are manually triggered pop-ups that provide extra information. For example, a shop might use a modal to explain what each condition grade of a refurbished phone means.

Modals make it possible to include all the required information on a page, without presenting users with a giant page full of text.

Modals are very useful for (but not limited to) people with cognitive impairments, people with ADHD, people with autism and screen reader users.

How to support it

In general, modals can be tricky to build accessibly. Important considerations include the user's focus and keyboard navigation.

- Move focus into the modal when it opens, and keep it there while it's open
- Let users close it with the Escape key as well as a visible close button
- Return focus to the element that opened it when it closes

Useful Links

Accessibility Essentials - Modals